



TRADE AND LABOR

IFIs look after money flows between countries and are like banks. But nations are also linked by other organizations. The World Trade Organization (WTO), set up in 1994, oversees trade, and regulates 95 percent of the world's financial services. It has legal powers to enforce its rules. The International Labor Organization tries to ensure fair working conditions around the world but lacks legal power.



WASHINGTON CONSENSUS

A loan from an IFI to a country in trouble comes with conditions. The IFIs impose measures, known as the Washington Consensus, to help the country's economy. Countries must, for instance, open up markets to international trade and reduce government intervention. But many argue the Consensus doesn't help the poorest people and simply increases the influence of global businesses.



GREEK BAILOUT

In 2009, Greece faced huge debts. The European Commission, European Central Bank, and IMF (the Troika or group of three) agreed to a bailout. In return the government had to make cuts in spending and sell state assets. In 2015, with services failing and unemployment rising, the Greek people voted in a new government in the hope of reversing the cuts. But the Troika bailout depended on the cuts continuing, so the country remains in turmoil.